# When the Lights Go Out

Many outages are short, and a few small things on hand make the wait comfortable instead of stressful.

## CHECKLIST

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ | LED lanterns for each main room | 2-pack about $12 |
| ☐ | Flashlights by the bed | $11-20 |
| ☐ | Phone power banks, charged | $9-20 each |
| ☐ | USB car charger as a backup | $5-15 |
| ☐ | Battery-powered carbon monoxide alarm | $25-28 |
| ☐ | Fridge and freezer thermometer | $10-12 |
| ☐ | Cooler and ice packs for food | cost varies |
| ☐ | Battery or hand-crank radio | $40-80 |
| ☐ | Written list of medical devices that need power, plus a plan | free |

From Ready.gov: keep the fridge and freezer closed; a fridge keeps food cold about 4 hours, a full freezer about 48 hours. Run generators only outdoors, at least 20 feet from windows.

## DO IT THIS WEEKEND

1. Put a thermometer in the fridge and freezer.
2. Charge all your power banks and stash them in one drawer.
3. Test or install a battery CO alarm on each level.
4. Bookmark your utility's outage page and our grid tracker.

## LEARN MORE

**BLACKOUT.NETWORK: US power grid**
blackout.network/grid

**BLACKOUT.NETWORK: Weather alerts**
blackout.network/weather

**BLACKOUT.NETWORK: Radio and scanners**
blackout.network/radio

**Ready.gov: Power outages**
ready.gov/power-outages

**American Red Cross: Power outage safety**
redcross.org